Architecture Decision Record

Record an important technical decision: its context, the options you considered, what you chose, and the trade-offs.

Manage Flow · Inspired by Michael Nygard's ADR Format · Decisions Worth Remembering

ADR NUMBER _____

DATE _____

1 Title & Status

ONE DECISION PER RECORD

Title (short, e.g. “Use event queues for order updates”): _____ Deciders: _____

Status: ☐ Proposed ☐ Accepted ☐ Rejected ☐ Deprecated ☐ Superseded by ADR # _____

2 Context

WHAT FORCES ARE AT PLAY?

The problem, the constraints, and why a decision is needed now

3 Decision Drivers

WHAT MATTERS MOST

e.g. cost, performance, team skills, time to market, security, reversibility

- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐

4 Options Considered

AT LEAST TWO, INCLUDING “DO NOTHING”

OPTION	PROS	CONS	EFFORT / COST	CHOSEN?

5 Decision

We will... _____

6 Consequences

WHAT BECOMES EASIER, AND HARDER

Easier / good

Harder / trade-offs

“Will someone joining next year understand why we did this?”

“What would make us revisit this decision?”

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